Talent

Progress Report 2 :
HCI Design

Gian Prem Rajaram	gian.rajaram.23@ucl.ac.uk
Sadhana Jayakumar	sadhana.jayakumar.25@ucl.ac.uk
Adam Benmohamed	adam.benmohamed.25@ucl.ac.uk
Lienqi Peng	lienqi.peng.25@ucl.ac.uk
Chengyu Yang	chengyu.yang.25@ucl.ac.uk

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Department of Computer Science

University College London

1. Similar Application Review

This section reviews existing platforms that partially overlap with the proposed CV concierge library. While none of these systems fully address the problem space, they provide useful points of comparison in terms of recruitment flow, consent handling, and discovery models.

1.1 LinkedIn

LinkedIn operates as a large-scale professional social network using a freemium model. Users can upload a CV-like profile and control visibility at a basic public or private level.

1.2.1 Strengths

1. Strong industry adoption and brand trust.
2. Passive discovery through recruiter search.
3. Messaging and networking features are mature.

1.2.2 Limitations

1. No institution-level verification for student status.
2. Visibility controls are coarse and binary rather than granular.
3. Students cannot give consent to specific organisations only.
4. Recruiter access prioritises paid subscriptions rather than ethical data access.
5. The platform is not specialised for “university students” or for students wanting a career in academia.

1.2 Handshake

Handshake is a university-focused recruitment platform widely used in higher education institutions. It follows an application-driven model where students actively apply for roles.

1.3.1 Strengths

1. Strong university integration and student verification
2. Trusted by institutions and career services
3. Centralised job postings

1.3.2 Limitations

1. No recruiter-led discovery without a job posting
2. Students must apply to be visible
3. Limited consent flexibility beyond application submission
4. CVs are not browsable assets
5. Recruitment interaction is one-directional

1.3 Otta

Otta is a modern job board focused primarily on technology roles. It uses profile matching and recommendation algorithms.

1.3.1 Strengths

1. Clean user experience
2. Skills-based matching
3. Transparency around employer interest

1.3.2 Limitations

1. Narrow industry focus
2. No academic or institutional verification
3. Limited consent controls
4. CV visibility is tied to platform matching logic
5. Not suitable for charities or non-tech employers

1.4 Competitive Gap Summary

Across all reviewed platforms, several consistent gaps emerge:

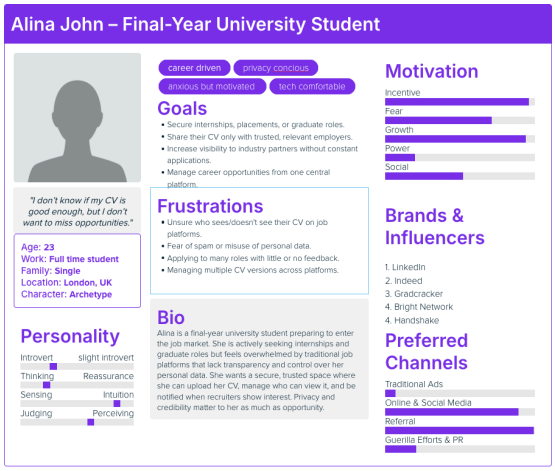
1. Lack of granular consent at the individual employer level
2. No CV library model that supports passive discovery with privacy
3. Limited support for early-stage students and academic credentials
4. Absence of institution-governed access control
5. Recruiter-centric monetisation rather than student protection

The proposed platform directly addresses these gaps by positioning the CV as a controlled digital asset rather than an application attachment. By allowing students to explicitly manage who can view their CV and when, the system introduces a privacy-first recruitment model aligned with academic and ethical standards.

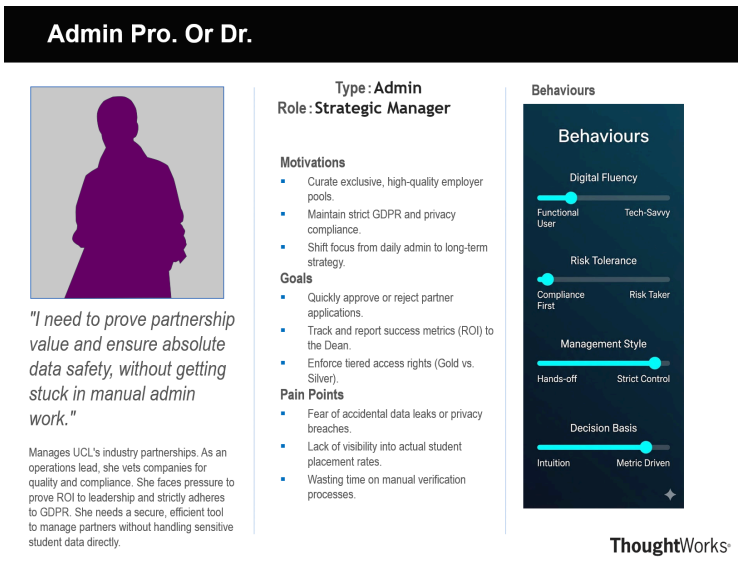
2. HCI DESIGN

2.1 Persona and Scenario

2.1.1 Student Persona



2.1.2 Admin Persona



2.1.3 Recruiter (Gold/Platinum/Silver)

2.2 Site Map by User

Student	[Student Sit Map Link]()
Recruiter Gold/Platinum	[Recruiter Gold/Platinum]()
Recruiter Silver	[Recruiter Site Map Link (Silver Tier))]()
Admin	[Admin Sit Map Link]()

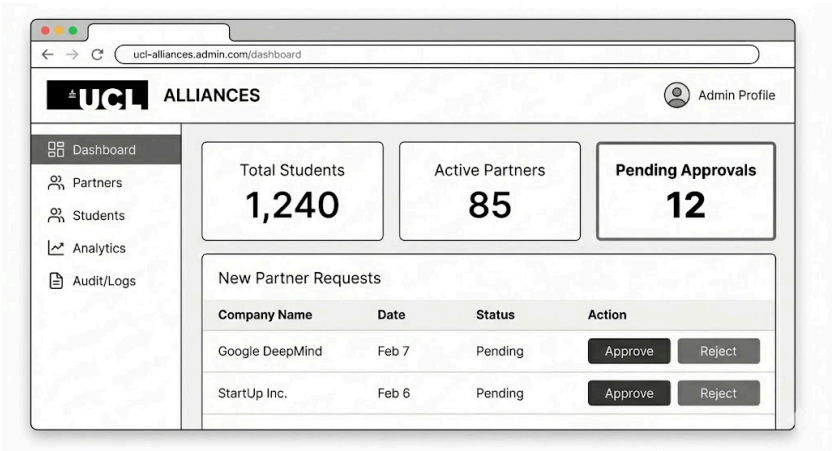
2.3 Design Principles

2.3.1 Paper Sketches

2.3.1.1 Admin:

2.3.2 Admin Wireframe

Technical implementation will build on existing UX principles in V0 Talent Platform shared by Dr. Daniel Hajas, and leverage UCL design component library.



2.3.3 Figma Prototype for Student/Recruiter/Admin user groups

Link: [Figma]

2.4 Evaluation

Report 1 Section 1.3 established **accessibility and inclusion** as core design principles for the platform. These requirements cover optimising for older devices with limited compute power, keyboard navigation and ESL considerations - informing heuristic evaluation and prototype

design decisions. Screen reader compatibility and assistive technology testing will be completed at the UAT phase to validate technical implementation.

2.4.1 Heuristic Evaluation

Evaluation Setup: 5 team members independently evaluated the Figma prototype (student, recruiter, Silver/Gold/Platinum, admin interfaces) against Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics using a 0-4 severity scale. Evaluation assessed effectiveness, efficiency, safety, utility, learnability and memorability across all user roles and tier levels. Findings were consolidated with duplicates removed, identifying 40 total issues documented below by interface type.

2.4.1.1 Student

Heuristic	Problem	Original Design	Solution	#
H1: Visibility of system status	No upload confirmation visible	CV upload page shows a button, but it's unclear if the upload succeeded	Uploaded CV appears in the CV Library section withthe filename shown	4
H2: Match between system and real world	Academic section formal labels	"Academic Achievements" and "Additional Academic Information" terminology	Simplified labels visible in navigation as "Academic Experience"	2
H3: User control and freedom	Cannot switch active CV	Multiple CVs are uploadable, but no clear active CV designationis visible	The CV Library section shows uploaded files with management options	3
H4: Consistency and standards	Navigation labels inconsistent	Left sidebar uses mix of terminology across different sections	Standardised navigation structure visible across all student pages	2
H5: Error prevention	Account deletion is visible without safeguards	The Delete Account section in Account Management shows a warning text list	Red warning box with 5-point checklist before deletion button	3
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	Profile updates multi-step	Students must navigate between the Academic, Skills, and CV pages separately	Profile completion indicator (58%) is visible, showing progress centrally	2
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	Access History cluttered table	The Complete Access Log table shows 8 columns of data	The table displays the company, recruiter name, role, date, and status in organised rows	2
H9: Pre-empt user errors	CV upload format unclear	The upload section lacks file type specifications visible	"Upload your CV" heading is present, but no format guidance is shown	3

2.4.1.2 Admin

Heuristic	Problem	Original Design	Solution	#
H1: Visibility of system status	Pending approvals not prominent	Dashboard shows "12 Companies" metric but pending count unclear	Highlight pending approvals separately with "12 Pending" alert badge	3
H2: Match between system and real world	Status badges colour-only	Table rows show green/blue/yellow badges without text labels	Verified: badges show "Active", "Pending" text - adequate labelling	1
H3: User control and freedom	Individual approval workflow	Partners table requires row-by-row approval action	Add checkbox selection for bulk approve/reject operations	3
H4: Consistency and standards	Table column spacing varies	Dashboard and Audit Log tables use different column widths	Standardise table layouts with consistent spacing across pages	2
H5: Error prevention	Company disable action exposed	Partners/Company page shows "Company Disabled" button at bottom	Red warning section visible but add confirmation modal requirement	4
H6: Recognition rather than recall	Company details require navigation	Admin must click into each company to view full verification info	Current profile page shows complete details - navigation necessary	2
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	Dashboard shows 4 chart types	Analytics Overview displays bar, line, area, and trend graphs	Simplify to 2 primary charts with tabs for additional metrics	2
H9: Pre-empt User Errors	Approval decision criteria missing	Partners table shows pending companies but no verification checklist	Add approval guidelines sidebar with domain verification steps	3

2.4.1.4 Recruiter (Silver Tier)

Heuristic	Problem	Original Design	Solution	#
H1: Visibility of system status	Silver Tier lacks an explanation of the features they have access to	Dashboard shows "Silver" badge with no tooltip or explanation of limitations	Add info icon next to badge: "Silver: Job board only. Upgrade for CV library"	3
H2: Match between system and real world	The job salary field has no guidance	Job Upload shows "Job Salary" dropdown with "Currency", but no amount format examples	Add a placeholder showing "e.g. £40,000-50,000" below the currency selector	2
H3: User control and freedom	Cannot save incomplete job posts	The Job Upload form shows "Cancel" and "Upload" buttons only	Add "Save Draft" button between Cancel and Upload	3

H4: Consistency and standards	Badge styling inconsistent	Dashboard bottom shows "Silver", "Accepted", "Pending", "Declined" badges using different colours and sizes	Standardise badge sizing and colour scheme across all status indicators	2
H5: Error prevention	Close job has no safeguard	The Job Posting page shows a red "Close Job" button with no confirmation visible	Add confirmation: "Close posting? Applicants can no longer apply"	4
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	Applicant actions require individual clicks	Applicant List shows "Shortlist" buttons per row, no bulk operations	Add row checkboxes with "Export Selected", enabling bulk export	3
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	Dashboard chart unlabelled	Profile page displays a chart with no title or axis labels	Added 'Recruitment Pipeline'	2
H9: Help users recognise, diagnose and recover from errors	Required job fields are unmarked	Job Upload shows "Job Description" and salary, but no asterisk indicating required	Add a red asterisk (*) next to required fields with a legend at the form top	2

2.4.1.4 Recruiter (Gold*/Platinum)

Figma prototype currently uses 'Platinum' wording for simplicity. Feature access will be the same across Gold & Platinum tiers

Heuristic	Problem	Original Design	Solution	#
H1: Visibility of system status	Dashboard metrics unlabelled	Dashboard shows "128", "4", "2" with a bar chart, but the numbers lack clear labels explaining what they represent	Add metric labels above numbers: "Total Views", "Active Jobs",, "Pending Responses"	4
H2: Match between system and real world	Search experience filter technical	Search Candidates shows "Experience: 0-2y, 3-5y, 5+y" using technical abbreviations	Replace with: "Graduate (0-2y)", "Mid-level (3-5y)", "Senior (5+y)"	3
H3: User control and freedom	Cannot clear multiple filters	Search Candidates displays active filter pills (React, Figma, Python, London) but requires removing each individually	Add "Clear All" button next to Search to reset all filters at once	2
H4: Consistency and standards	Card layouts differ across pages	Saved Favorites cards show name/role/company while Anonymous Previews cards show skills/education/location	Standardise candidate card format across Saved Favorites, Search, and Anonymous Previews	2
H5: Error prevention	Save favourite has no confirmation	The Saved Favourites star icon can be clicked to remove but no undo or confirmation	Add confirmation tooltip: "Remove from favourites?" with undo option	2
H6: Recognition rather than recall	Job Analytics charts unlabelled	Job Analytics shows "Conversion Funnel" and "Source of Hire" visualisations but no axis labels or legends	Add percentage labels to funnel stages, legend for pie chart colour coding	3

H9: Pre-empt user errors	Required fields unmarked in Create Job	The Create Job form shows "Job Name", "Job Description", "Job Salary" but missed required field indicators.	Add red asterisk *() to required fields with "* Required" legend at top	3
H10: Help & documentation	Anonymous Previews purpose unclear	Anonymous Previews page shows candidate cards but no explanation of what information is hidden vs visible	Add info banner: "Preview shows: Skills, Education, Location. Hidden: Name, Contact until access granted"	4

2.4.2 Usability Testing

Evaluation Method: Due to the static wireframe format, usability evaluation was completed via 3 team-members simulating task execution to predict completion barriers. Evaluation assessed effectiveness, efficiency, safety, utility, learnability and memorability across student, recruiter and admin workflows.

3. Project Management

Project Status: On track

2-week plan: Draft High-Level Design document by 13-Feb, set up Github ticketing for project management, split target tech work into 5-10 smaller components, identify owners, start development work and draft Low-Level Design Documents.

Contributions:

Chengyu Yang: Responsible for the admin site map, personas, sketches, wireframes, and Figma designs.

Sadhana Jayakumar: Led student-related sitemap and figma designs, established local development environment and validated codebase, and finished all student view pages in Figma.

Lienqi Peng: Co-led Recruiter, Gold/Platinum site map. Led Figma designs, paper sketches and Wireframes.

Gian Rajaram: Co-Led Recruiter, Gold/Platinum site map. Completed Recruiter persona, supported heuristic/usability evaluation.

Adam Benmohamed: Recruiter Silver Site map, involved in creating a lot of base designs for the Figma recruiter page, involving Silver, Gold and Platinum tiers, also helped refine the overall layout and design of it.